

Github page & User Journey Map

A Comprehensive Guide to GitHub Personal Websites and Designing User
Journey Maps

Part 1

Your Personal Website on
GitHub

Registering Your Account



1. Sign Up

Navigate to **GitHub.com** and enter your email. Choose a professional username, as this will become the base URL for your future personal website.



2. Verification

Enter the verification code sent to your email address to unlock your new account.

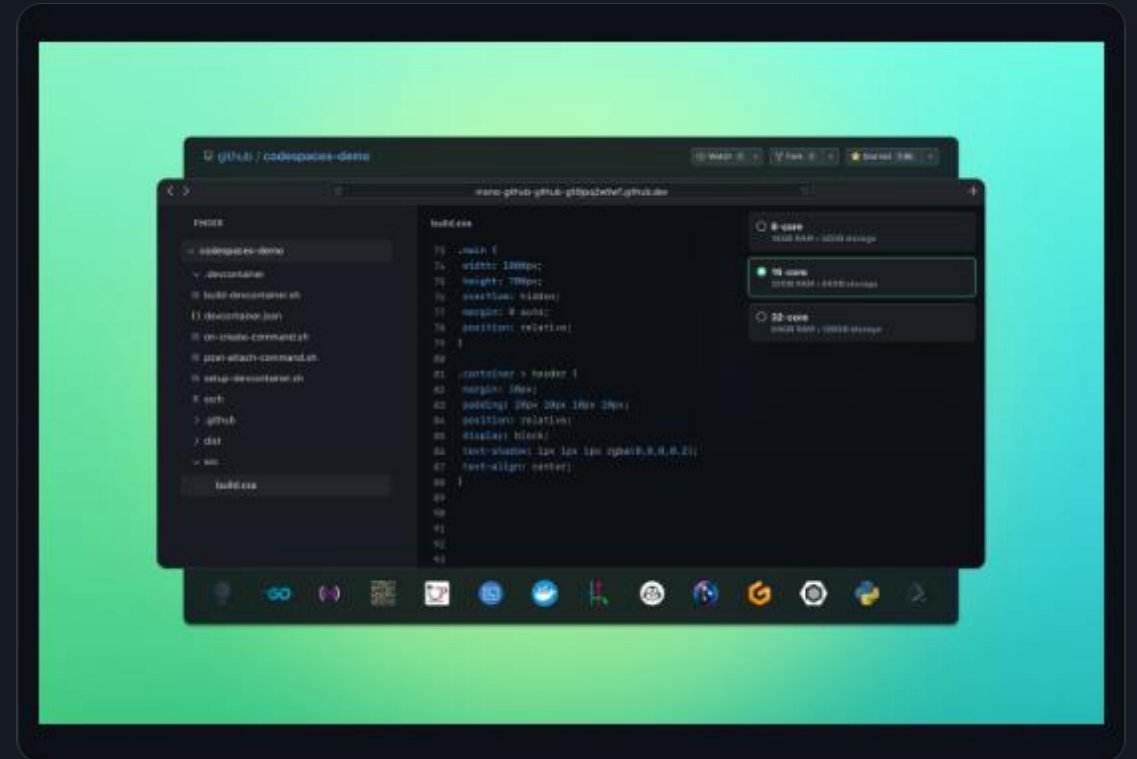


3. Profile Setup

Add a professional avatar, fill out your public bio, and link your existing portfolios or social networks to establish your digital identity.

Opening Your Repository

- > **The Magic Naming Convention:** Click "New Repository". You must name your repository strictly as `username.github.io` for GitHub Pages to activate automatically.
- > **Public Visibility:** Set the repository visibility to "Public" so that anyone on the internet can access and view your personal website.
- > **Initialize with a README:** Check the box to add a README file. This creates an initial commit and a main branch, which is required for deployment.



Activating & Designing

Complete guide: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5XhxR9Vs6zc>
<https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV12H4y1N7Q4>

Activating Pages

Navigate to your repository "Settings" and select the "Pages" tab on the left sidebar. Under "Build and deployment", ensure the source is set to "Deploy from a branch". Select your main branch and click save. Your site URL will be generated within minutes.

Designing Your Site

GitHub allows you to choose a pre-made Jekyll theme directly from the settings menu for a quick start. Alternatively, for full control, you can push your own raw index.html, CSS, and JS files directly to the root of the repository.

Part 2

Designing a User Journey Map

Mapping: Step-by-Step



1. Define Persona

Start by identifying the specific user profile and their distinct goal. A journey map must always be anchored to a specific user context.



2. Map the Stages

Break the timeline down into chronological phases. Standard phases often include Discovery, Consideration, Decision, Action, and Retention.



3. Plot Touchpoints

Map every interaction the user has with your product. Track their emotional highs and lows to locate specific pain points and delights.

Map Key Considerations

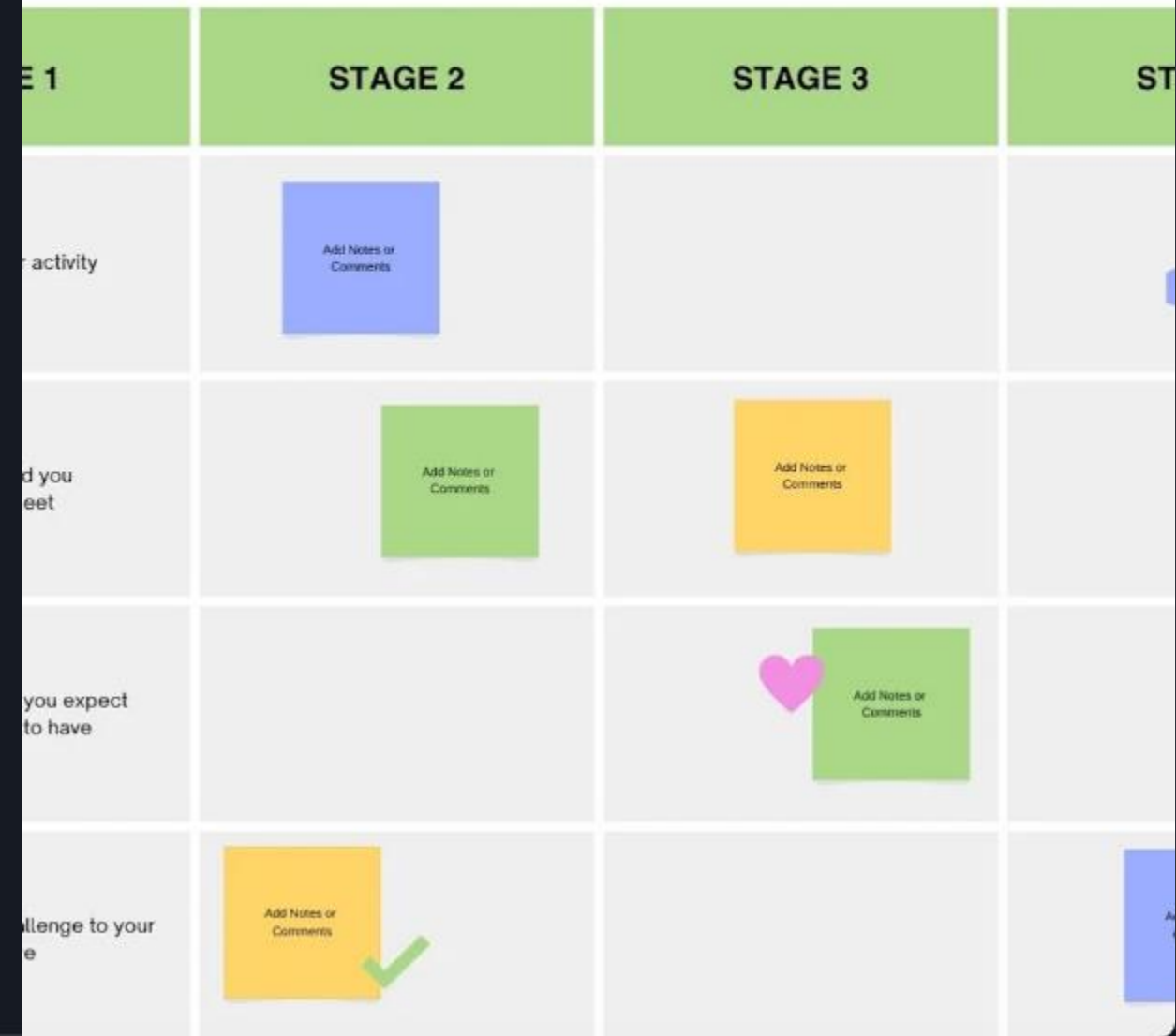
Rely on Real Data: Always base your journey map on real user research, interviews, and analytics. Building maps on internal assumptions leads to a fundamentally flawed product strategy.

Highlight Pain Points: Negative emotional dips on your journey map are actually your biggest assets. They clearly represent the best opportunities for product improvement and design innovation.

Maintain Scannability: A successful journey map balances dense detail with visual scannability, ensuring stakeholders can grasp the core narrative at a glance.

Journey Map

User Journey
the customer
want you

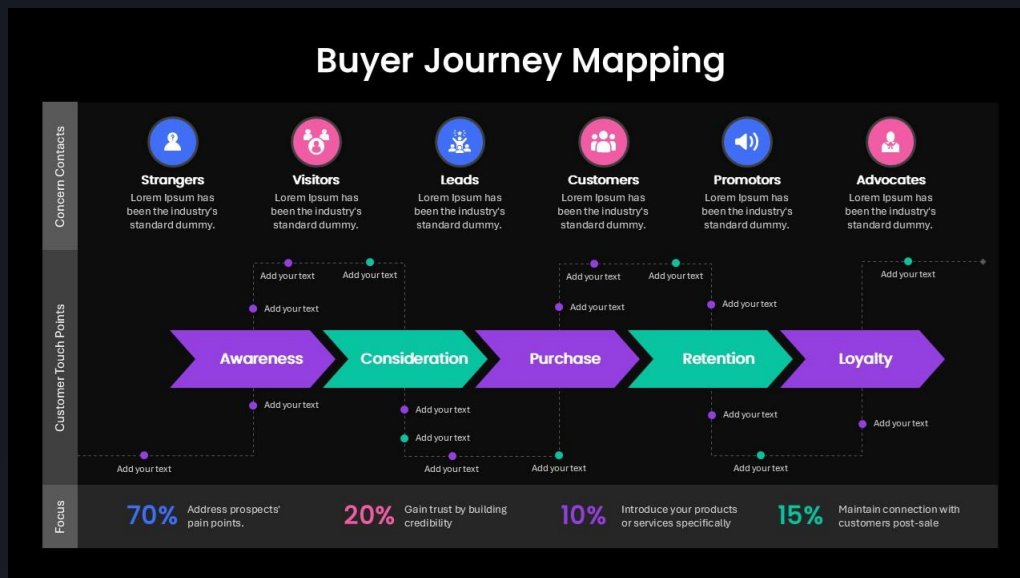


Opening Circle: Understanding User Research

- Today we're learning how to create user journey maps to understand your users' experiences
- A user journey map is a visual representation showing what actions users take, their goals, emotions, and pain points
- This skill helps you design products that actually meet customer needs



What Is a User Journey Map?



- User journey maps show the complete experience a user has with your product over time
- They include user actions, goals, emotions, thoughts, and pain points across different stages
- Journey maps help teams align on customer priorities and identify opportunities for improvement
- They transform abstract user feedback into concrete, visual insights that stakeholders can understand

Key Components of a Journey Map

- User Persona: A detailed profile of your target user including demographics, goals, and motivations
- Journey Stages: Sequential steps the user takes (like Discovery, Download, Onboarding, Retention, Advocacy)
- User Actions: What the user does at each stage of their journey
- Emotions and Thoughts: How the user feels and what they're thinking throughout their experience
- Pain Points: Frustrations, obstacles, or challenges the user encounters

Preparing Your Journey Map Template

- Start with a template to save time and maintain consistency across your team
- Customize the user persona section with a relevant image and profile information
- Define your specific journey stages based on your product (don't use generic stages)
- Add any pre-collected user pain points or actions to keep the team focused
- Consider duplicating and publishing your customized version as a team template for future use



Preparing Your Journey Map Template

Miro: <https://miro.com/templates/customer-journey-maps/>

Figma: <https://www.figma.com/templates/customer-journey-mapping/>

Downloadable Resource:

<https://www.sketchappsources.com/free-source/3131-journey-map-templates-sketch-freebie-resource.html>

Setting Up for Collaboration



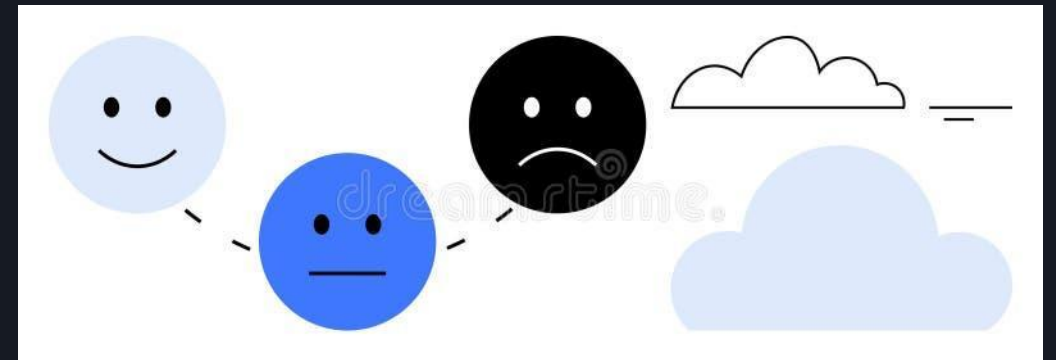
- Invite all stakeholders to your journey map session via email or shared link
- Ensure permissions are set so everyone can edit and contribute their ideas
- Set a clear time limit for the exercise to keep the team on task
- Start an audio chat so team members can discuss ideas in real time
- Establish ground rules: listen actively, build on others' ideas, focus on the user perspective

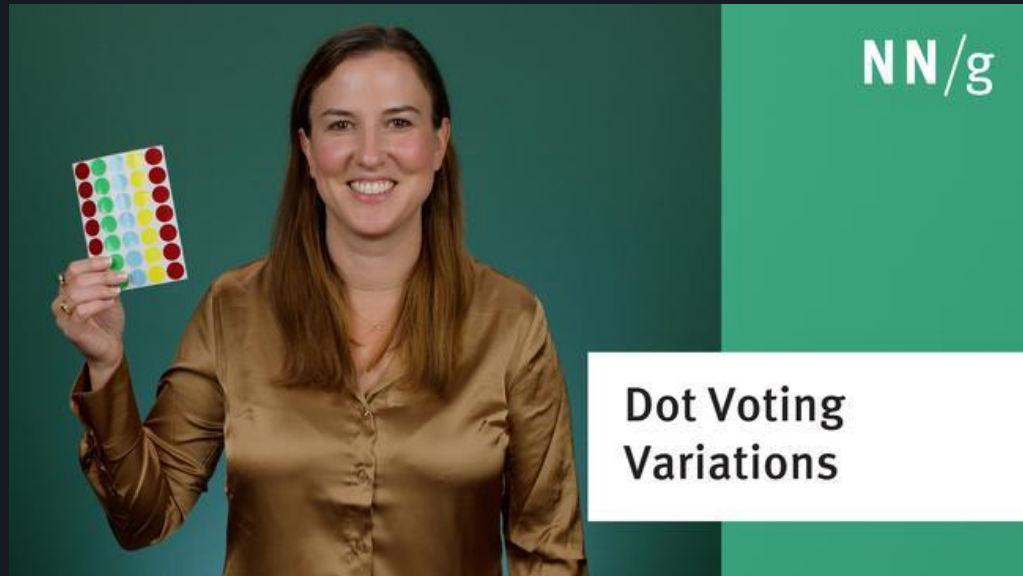
Filling Out User Actions and Goals

- Use sticky notes to add user actions and goals for each journey stage
- Keep each sticky note focused on one specific action or goal
- Connect sticky notes with arrow connectors to show the sequential flow of the user journey
- Customize connector colors and styles to make relationships clear
- Compass Points Protocol: Move to a corner based on which journey stage you know most about (North: Discovery, South: Advocacy, East: Onboarding, West: Retention)

Visualizing Emotions and Pain Points

- Use emojis or stickers to represent user emotions without relying only on text
- Add meaningful customer quotes alongside emojis to illustrate what each emotion represents
- Document pain points as separate sticky notes or highlighted sections
- Use stamps to give quick reactions to pain points and opportunities identified by teammates
- Back-to-Back, Face-to-Face Protocol: Partner with someone, stand back-to-back, then turn to face them and share one pain point you identified and one opportunity to address it





Identifying Opportunities and Priorities

- As a team, review all the pain points and opportunities you've identified on the map
- Run a voting session where each team member selects their top priorities
- Use anonymous voting to ensure unbiased decision-making
- Discuss the results and align on which opportunities to focus on next
- Create actionable tasks directly from sticky notes using task management widgets

Turning Insights Into Action

- Connect your journey map insights to your product roadmap and quarterly objectives
- Create specific, measurable tasks from the opportunities you've identified
- Assign ownership and deadlines to each action item
- Use your journey map as a reference document for future design and development decisions
- Share the completed map with your broader team so everyone understands the user perspective

Embedding Your Map

- > **Export Format:** Export your completed user journey map from your design software as a high-resolution PNG, WebP, or SVG file.
- > **Repository Storage:** Upload this image file into an `/assets` or `/images` folder within your newly created GitHub repository.
- > **Markdown Integration:** Use Markdown syntax such as `![Journey Map](./assets/map.png)` to embed the visual directly into your `README.md`.
- > **HTML Embedding:** Alternatively, use a standard HTML tag inside your `index.html` file to display the map on your personal website.



The End-to-End Workflow



||

Design is not just what it looks like
and feels like. Design is how it
works.

||

— Steve Jobs

Questions?

Ready to launch your site and showcase your designs.